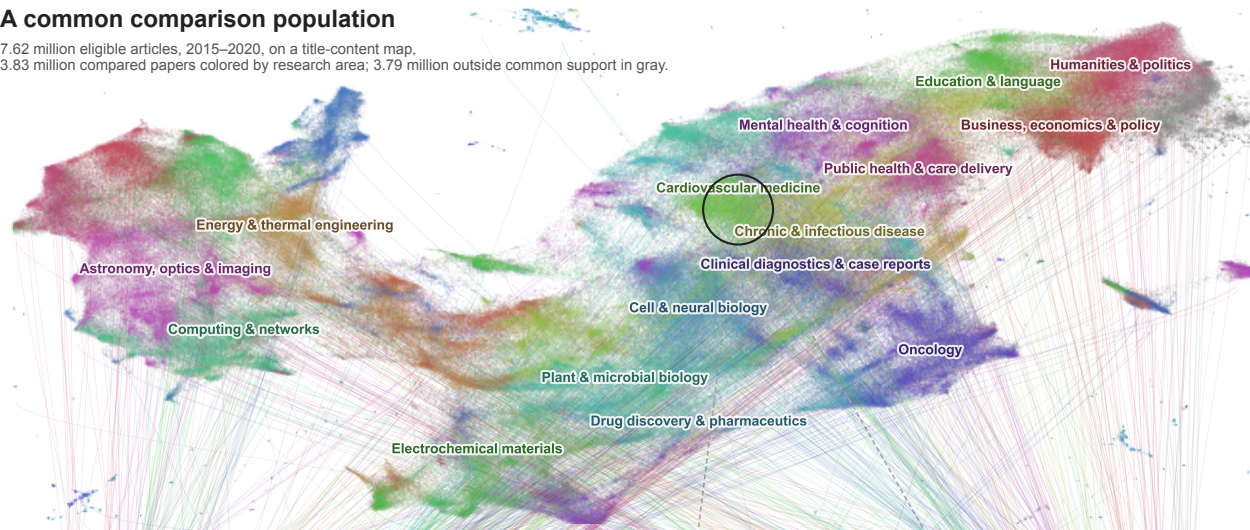
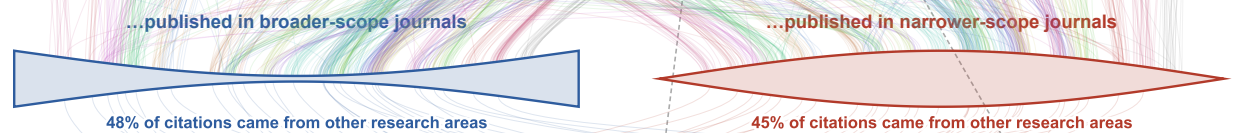


**a A common comparison population**

7.62 million eligible articles, 2015–2020, on a title-content map.  
3.83 million compared papers colored by research area; 3.79 million outside common support in gray.

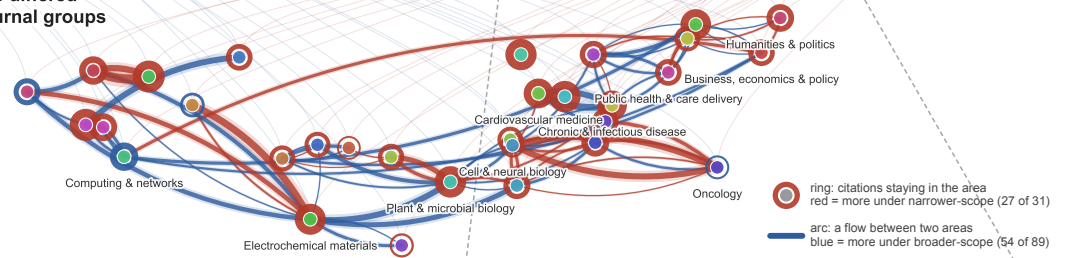


**b**

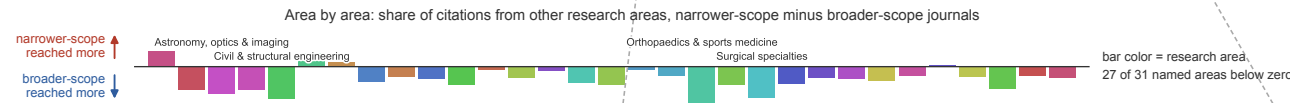


**c**

**How citation origins differed between the two journal groups**

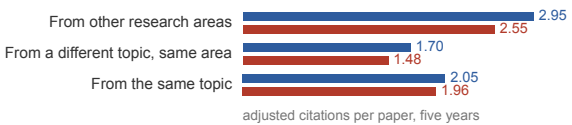


**d**



**e**

**Across all 3,818,173 compared papers**



**9.2% lower** other-area citations per same-topic citation (1.30 vs 1.44; 95% CI, 4.8% to 13.4% lower)

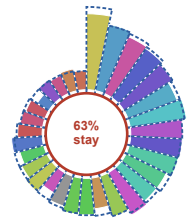
**f**

**Cardiovascular medicine overall**

**Scope examples only: Echocardiography (0.87) and Internal Medicine (0.84)**

Across all journals in this area: 63% stayed under narrower-scope publication, 58% under broader-scope; 1.06 vs 1.20 other-area citations per same-topic citation.

Wedges: share of the area's citations from each other research area under narrower-scope publication; dashed outline, the broader-scope value.



- Astronomy, optics & imaging
- Chronic & infectious disease
- Computing & networks
- Education & language
- Energy & thermal engineering
- Mathematics & theoretical physics
- Oncology
- Reproduction, metabolism & animal science
- Business, economics & policy
- Civil & structural engineering
- Drug discovery & pharmaceuticals
- Electrical & control engineering
- Humanities & politics
- Mental health & cognition
- Orthopaedics & sports medicine
- Social behavior & violence
- Cardiovascular medicine
- Climate, land & agriculture
- Earth & environmental science
- Electrochemical materials
- Immune & inflammatory disease
- Metallurgy & alloys
- Plant & microbial biology
- Surgical specialties
- Cell & neural biology
- Clinical diagnostics & case reports
- Ecology & taxonomy
- Electronic & magnetic materials
- Marine ecology & paleoscience
- Mixed records
- Public health & care delivery
- Synthetic chemistry